Phakding → Namche Bazaar

Everest Base Camp Trek · Day 4 · Khumbu Region, Nepal

ORIENT WHAT THE ROUTE IS LIKE

An 11.1 km hike from Phakding (2,610 m) to Namche Bazaar (3,440 m) — the classic acclimatisation day on the Everest Base Camp trail. Trek begins on a gentle undulating path along the Dudh Kosi river, crossing three suspension bridges including the **Hillary Bridge** at km 7. The final 600 m of climb — from the bridge to Namche — is the hard section: switchbacks through blue pine forest, gaining 550 m in under 3 km. Porters and yak trains share the trail; pass them on the uphill side and wait for them to clear on bridges.

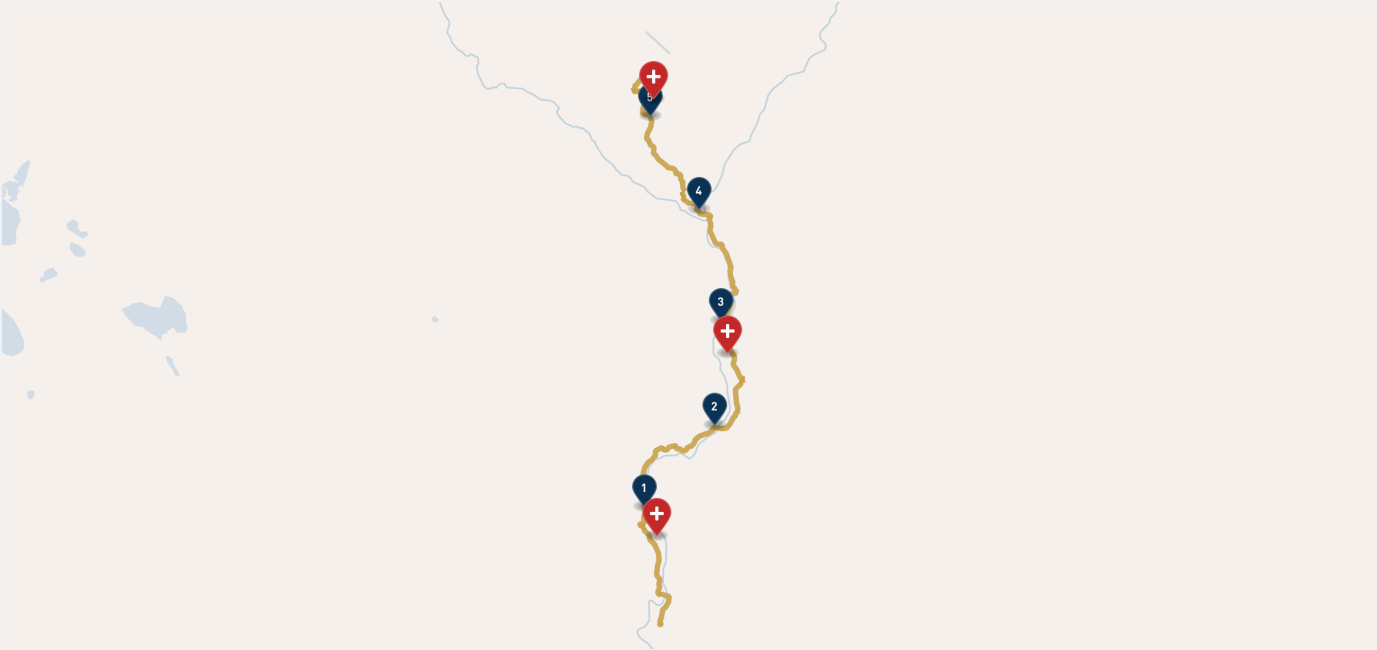
11.1	1766	43.5%	3h 34
DISTANCE	CLIMB	STEEPEST	MOVING TIME
km · single stage	m cumulative gain	over 200 m window	@ 2 km/h

FRAME WHY THE DETAILS MATTER

The Phakding-Namche ascent is the **first altitude test** of the trek. Acute mountain sickness starts appearing above 2,500 m — pay attention to headache, nausea, and appetite loss on the Namche climb. The three health posts below are the **nearest medical resources** to the 2, 6, and 10 km waypoints — Pasang Lhamu Memorial Hospital in Namche is the only facility with altitude-sickness expertise. Save the numbers before trail coverage drops.

PRESENT ROUTE · WAYPOINTS EVERY 2 KM · NEAREST EMERGENCY RESOURCES

Waypoint (every 2 km) · Emergency facility · Route



PRESENT NEAREST EMERGENCY RESOURCES

NEAREST TO WAYPOINT 1 · KM 2

Himalayan Sherpa Hospital

Khumbu Pasang Lhamu Rural Municipality 03, 00000, Nepal

980-1808848

Rating: 5★ (4 reviews)

0.43 km from waypoint

NEAREST TO WAYPOINT 3 · KM 6

Manjo Community Health Clinic

QPFC+5QQ, Khumjung 56000, Nepal

981-4794801

0.45 km from waypoint

NEAREST TO WAYPOINT 5 · KM 10

Um Hong Gil Namche Community Hospital

Namche Marg, Namche 56000, Nepal

038-540036

Rating: 3.4★ (5 reviews)

0.23 km from waypoint

BRIDGE · BEFORE YOU SET OFF

→ **Save the three health-post phone numbers** offline — trail coverage is patchy above Monjo.

→ **See page 2** for the altitude-specific pacing plan and AMS symptom checklist.

→ **Carry one water bottle filtered or sterilised** plus one spare; refill at tea houses every hour.

GPX source: local file · Hospitals via Google Places

How the route actually feels

Elevation, pacing, seasonality — what the numbers on page 1 mean on the ground

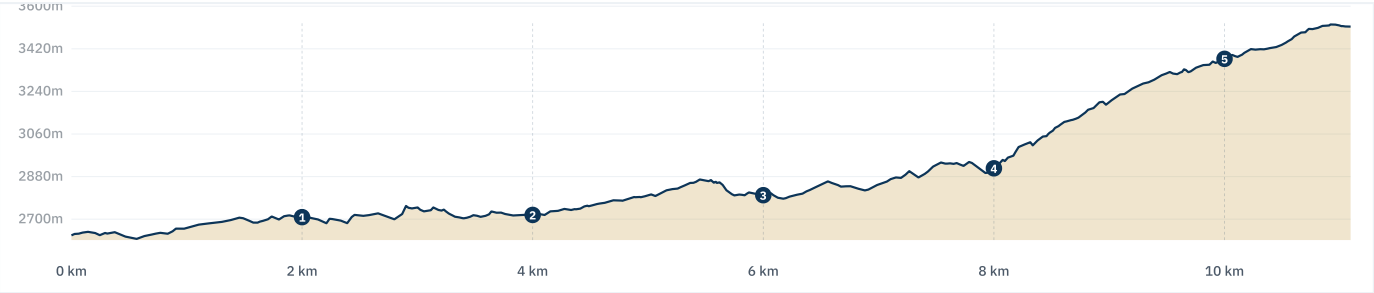
ORIENT WHAT THE TERRAIN FEELS LIKE

The profile is **deceptively bimodal**. The first 7 km along the river gain only 130 m — easy walking. From km 7 (the Hillary Bridge at the Dudh Kosi / Bhote Kosi confluence) to Namche at km 11, the trail climbs 825 m in under 3 km — a sustained 43.5% grade on loose dust and rock. Total cumulative gain is 1766 m. The high point on this day is 3522 m — well into the altitude zone.

FRAME WHERE THE REAL DIFFICULTY LIVES

Trekkers underestimate this day because the first half is easy. The **real danger is pace on the Namche climb**, combined with dehydration and the first real altitude exposure. Target 1.5 – 2 km/h on the climb — slow enough to hold a conversation without breathing hard. Stop every 10 minutes, sip water every stop, and do not push through a headache.

PRESENT ELEVATION PROFILE



PRESENT WAYPOINT REGISTER

#	DISTANCE	ELEVATION	COORDINATES (LAT, LNG)
1	**2 km**	2709 m	27.75414, 86.71048
2	**4 km**	2718 m	27.76415, 86.72020
3	**6 km**	2801 m	27.77694, 86.72110
4	**8 km**	2915 m	27.79055, 86.71806
5	**10 km**	3378 m	27.80204, 86.71129

PRESENT PRACTICAL TIPS

Season
Oct–Nov (best) and Mar–Apr. Avoid Jun–Sep monsoon; leeches, slick trail, and closed flights into Lukla.

Direction
Uphill one way only — descend to Lukla after Everest Base Camp. Do not skip rest day at Namche.

Water
Tea-house water needs filtering or SteriPen. Bottled water is available but creates waste and costs ₹100–300.

Meals
Dal bhat at Jorsale (km 5) is the last riverside lunch stop. Namche has more options but arrives after the climb.

Gear
Poles strongly recommended for the Namche climb. Headlamp in the pack even for day stages — winter dusk is sudden.

Navigation
Single main trail, well-trafficked. GPS helpful near Jorsale checkpoint where side-trails branch.

PRESENT EMERGENCY CONTACTS

NEPAL EMERGENCY
112
Ambulance · police · fire

HIMALAYAN RESCUE
+977 1-4440292
Pheriche aid post · altitude illness

ETI360 DUTY LINE
+977 98 XXX XXXX
On-trip support

BRIDGE · DAY-OF CHECKLIST

- **AMS** — if headache + nausea together, stop climbing. Do not ascend further that day.
- **Pacing** — finish at Namche before 14:00 to allow acclimatisation afternoon and weather-change margin.
- **Water** — target 4 L over the day; altitude dehydrates faster than temperature suggests.
- **Incident** — note your waypoint number before calling; helicopter evac from anywhere past Monjo means descending to Lukla first.

Elevation min/max: 2603–3522 m · descent: 884 m total